

MBA

MBA Fastrack 2025

Verbal Ability and Reading Comprehension

DPP: 7

RC -Tone and Structure Questions

Direction (1 - 4) Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

Estimates vary, but about half of everyone who experiences sleep paralysis will have hypnagogic hallucinations at the same time. Hypnagogia refers to unusual experiences around the boundaries of sleep: the shout of a name, a flicker out of the corner of your eye, or even a sudden touch as you drift off. The most common hypnagogic experience in sleep paralysis is this mysterious 'feeling of presence': the sensation that someone is there, without any clear sensory evidence or even any input from the outside world. And the presences that come during sleep paralysis are often of the worst kind – pure malevolence, as if something had just stepped straight out of a nightmare and into your bedroom.

Feelings of presence (FP) are, at their core, just that: feelings. While we routinely think of hallucinations as auditory or visual in nature, the FP experience involves the mere sense that someone else is present without a visual, auditory or sensory cue. This isn't about hearing or seeing someone, nor does it involve a touch on your shoulder. People land on this term – presence – because they don't know how else to describe the sensation. Something basic and invisible, a feeling you know if you've had it, but struggle to put into words for someone else.

Despite the challenge of describing presences, there's increasing awareness that they may actually be relatively common across a range of different contexts. For example, feelings of presence are reported by lots of people with Parkinson's disease, alongside other kinds of hallucination. FP reveal themselves in a huge number of survival stories, particularly for mountaineers, climbers and polar explorers, in which they are known as the 'third man' effect. And for people who are grieving, the loss of a person can often be associated with an ongoing sensation of presence.

...I wanted to know more about what that really meant because it didn't fit with most models for how we understand hallucinations. Hallucinations are perceptual experiences without any corresponding sensory input from the world outside. They are usually distinguished from other phenomena like illusions, in which there is an input that you misinterpret; haze on the horizon that creates a mirage is an example of an illusion. But a feeling of presence isn't supposed to involve any perceptual content. It lacks the stimuli on the outside, but it's not even clear what the feeling is on the inside.

There are a few different ways you can approach this question. It could be that people don't really mean they can actually sense someone else there. For example, some people swear that they know when they are being watched, as if they had eyes in the back

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of their head. It's probably fair to say that many researchers would not consider this an actual phenomenon, but it could be that FP and the feeling of being watched reflect the same thing: people feeling uneasy in new or uncertain environments. Heightened anxiety, a chill down the back of your neck, a sense of paranoia – each of these could contribute to something like a presence.

Another possibility is that felt presence may be a secondary interpretation, prompted by other unusual experiences. Take hearing voices as an example. If you were used to hearing a disembodied voice all the time, you might come to expect or believe that a person is there, even when silent. It wouldn't take much to give someone that feeling. Many of us might hear a noise in another room and go and check in case someone is there, with a vague and uneasy feeling that the noise could have been made only by a person. For a fleeting moment, a sensory cue such as a sound might give rise to the distinct feeling that an unseen person is there.

- Q1** According to the passage, our understanding of hallucination can be best described as:
- (A) Perceptual experiences that involve misinterpretation of external stimuli, typically causing illusions like a mirage.
 - (B) Sensory experiences involving the perception of things that are not physically present, often occurring without any external stimuli.
 - (C) An interpretation of vague sensations, like feelings of presence, that can arise from emotional responses such as anxiety or grief, without any clear sensory perception.
 - (D) Perceptual distortions where hallucinations are caused by familiar stimuli, such as hearing disembodied

voices, leading to a secondary belief of an unseen presence.

- Q2** All of the following have been used in the passage as examples of the FP (Feeling of Presence) experience, except:
- (A) Survivors of extreme environments, such as mountaineers and polar explorers, experiencing the 'third man' effect.
 - (B) People with Parkinson's disease reporting the sensation of someone being present, along with other hallucinations.
 - (C) Individuals grieving the loss of a loved one, experiencing a continued sense of presence after the person's death.
 - (D) Those suffering from sleep paralysis, who hear voices during hypnagogic hallucinations.
- Q3** Which of the following set of keywords from the passage best encapsulates the contents of the passage?
- (A) Hypnagogic, hallucinations, sleep paralysis, presence, grief, paranoia, sensory input, illusion
 - (B) Hallucination, auditory, visual, tactile, disembodied voices, illusions, presence, anxiety
 - (C) Presence, hallucinations, sensory input, hypnagogic, interpretation, illusion, stimuli, anxiety
 - (D) Hallucinations, FP, presence, sleep paralysis, anxiety, disembodied voices, survival, illusion
- Q4** Suggest the most appropriate title for the given passage.
- (A) The Science Behind Hallucinations and Illusions
 - (B) Exploring the Unseen: Feelings of Presence and Their Mysteries



- (C) Hypnagogic Hallucinations: A Study of Sleep Paralysis and Sensory Cues
 (D) Hallucinations in Sleep: From Paranoia to Perception

Direction (5 - 8) Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

Read the given passages carefully and answer the questions given below each passage.

In February 1884, the English art critic and polymath John Ruskin took the lectern at the London Institution for a pair of lectures on the weather. 'The Storm-Cloud of the Nineteenth Century' was his invective against a particular 'wind of darkness' and 'plague-cloud' that, in his estimate, had begun to envelope Victorian cities only in recent years. He had been taking careful meteorological measurements, he told a sceptical audience. He railed against the 'bitterness and malice' of the new weather in question; and, perhaps more importantly, about how it mirrored a certain societal 'moral gloom'. You could read in us what you could read in the weather, he suggested.

It was easy that February, and perhaps easy today, to disregard any alleged winds of darkness as the ravings of a madman. Clouds are clouds: even if Ruskin's existed – which was a question of some contemporaneous debate – it would be untoward to imagine they bore any relationship with the human psyche. As Brian Dillon observed of the cloud lectures in The Paris Review in 2019, it can be hard to tell where Ruskin's 'bad weather ends and his own ragged, doleful mood begins.' In 1886, Ruskin suffered a mental breakdown while giving a talk in Oxford. By the end of his life at the turn of the century, he was widely considered insane. His ramblings on meteorology and the human spirit aren't exactly treated with the same gravitas as his books on J M W Turner.

And yet, for Ruskin, the clouds weren't just clouds: they were juiced up by a 'dense manufacturing mist', as he'd noted in a diary entry. The plague-clouds embodied the miasma of the Industrial Revolution; the moral gloom was specifically that which arose from the rapid societal and environmental changes that were afoot. Ruskin's era had seen relentless transformation of pastoral landscapes into industrial hubs. Everything smelled like sulphur and suffering. Soot-filled air, chemical and human waste, the clamour of machinery – these were more than just physical nuisances. They were assaults on the senses, shaping moods and behaviour in ways that were not yet fully understood.

Ruskin believed that the relentless pace of industrialisation, with its cacophony of tools and sprawling factories and environmental destruction, undermined psychological wellbeing: that the mind, much like the body, required a healthy social and physical environment to thrive. This was actually a somewhat new idea. (Isaac Ray, a founder of the American Psychiatric Association, wouldn't define the idea of 'mental hygiene', the precursor to mental health, until 1893.) Instability in the environment, for Ruskin, begot instability in the mind. One reflected the other.

More than a century later, as we grapple with a new suite of breakneck environmental changes, the plague-clouds are again darkly literal. Global average surface temperatures have risen by about 1.1°C (2°F) since the pre-industrial era, with most of this warming occurring in the past 40 years. Ice is melting; seas are steadily rising; storms are – well, you know this story. And yet, most frequently, it is still a story of the world out there: the world outside of us. The narrative of climate change



is one of meteorological extremes, economic upheaval and biodiversity losses. But perhaps it is worth taking a maybe-mad Ruskin seriously. What of our internal clouds? As the climate crisis warps weather and acidifies oceans and shatters temperature records with frightening regularity, one is tempted to ask if our minds are changing in kind.

Q5 Which of the following options offers the best continuation of the passage after the final paragraph?

- (A) It is important to recognize that, just as the environment shapes our mental state, our collective mindset can also influence the way we approach environmental issues. By fostering a global awareness of the interconnection between climate change and mental health, we can encourage policies and practices that address both the external and internal impacts of environmental degradation.
- (B) Ruskin's ideas, though dismissed by many in his time, have found a new resonance in the modern world. The growing field of environmental psychology seeks to understand how natural environments, or the lack thereof, affect human behavior and mental health. As we continue to witness the consequences of climate change, this field may offer insights into how we can adapt both mentally and socially to our changing world.
- (C) In light of the ongoing environmental crises, it becomes crucial to reconsider the role of industry and urbanization in our society. Perhaps a return to simpler, more sustainable ways of living, as advocated by Ruskin, could mitigate not only the physical damage to the planet but also the

psychological toll on its inhabitants. The restoration of natural landscapes might be a key component in healing both our planet and our minds.

- (D) While Ruskin's concerns about the impact of industrialization on the human psyche were ahead of his time, it is essential to ground our understanding of climate change in scientific evidence. The mental effects of environmental degradation are real, but they must be studied rigorously to avoid the pitfalls of speculation and to ensure that solutions are based on sound scientific principles.

Q6 Which among the following options best describes the tone of the passage?

- (A) Reflective and analytical
- (B) Pensive and foreboding
- (C) Optimistic and hopeful
- (D) Critical and investigative.

Q7 According to the passage, which of the following inferences, if true, would strengthen Ruskin's arguments the most?

- (A) Recent studies in environmental psychology have shown a strong correlation between increasing rates of mental health issues and the rapid pace of environmental degradation, suggesting that external environmental changes have a profound impact on the human psyche.
- (B) Historical records indicate that periods of intense industrialization have consistently coincided with increased reports of mental health disorders, supporting Ruskin's claim that the environmental effects of industrialization contribute to psychological instability.



(C) Meteorological data from the 19th century confirm that the 'plague-clouds' described by Ruskin were indeed real and that these clouds were composed of pollutants from industrial factories, which had tangible effects on both the environment and the population's health.

(D) Advances in climatology have revealed that the specific weather patterns Ruskin observed were a result of natural cycles rather than industrial activity, challenging the notion that industrialization directly influences psychological wellbeing.

Q8 "You could read in us what you could read in the weather, he suggested." What purpose does this sentence serve in the context of the passage?

(A) It introduces Ruskin's argument that the physical environment and human emotions are intrinsically linked, setting the stage for his critique of industrialization.

(B) It reflects Ruskin's belief that the emotional and psychological states of individuals are a direct reflection of the environmental conditions they live in, challenging conventional views on the separation between nature and human psychology.

(C) It contrasts Ruskin's personal observations with the scientific community's skepticism, highlighting the divide between his views and mainstream meteorology.

(D) It emphasizes Ruskin's belief that the environmental changes brought by industrialization were not only physical but also moral, reflecting the broader societal decay.

Direction (9 - 12) Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

As a child, for every summer vacation, my parents took me to Kerala in southern India to spend three months with my aunt in her large family-estate. It was an age before televisions were widely available and therefore at night-time she told us stories from the vast oeuvre of Indian mythologies called the 'puranas'. These stories often involved a moral exemplar as a protagonist – a hero who embodied Immanuel Kant's 'categorical imperative' – whose life's arc exemplified devotion, truth, sacrifice, love and other ennobling ideas. The dramatic twists in these stories came from the gods and their caprice, which tested the commitments of righteous men and women in the face of opportunities to abandon their ideals and save themselves. They invariably never did, at great cost to themselves. My aunt referred to these men and women as 'symbols of dharma' (*dharma prateekam*), although she left that capacious word – *dharma* – unexplained.

[...]The locus of virtue in those stories lay not in ritual or rank but in sustaining commitment to an ideal that demanded some form of sacrifice. When faced with morally complex situations in their own lives – be they a child listening to his aunt, or an audience hearing them from a religious teacher – the listeners could theoretically ask themselves: 'What would Shrivatsa the filial son do?' Or: 'What would Savitri the faithful wife do?'

[...]But beyond such instances of moral emulation, at the heart of this pedagogic agenda was also a model of how humans are born: they emerge in a new womb carrying along with them all the deeds and knowledge from their previous lives. The role of these stories is therefore more than just simple moralising: by emulating the actions they prescribe, the stories help cleanse the mind,



like a previously used but unwashed utensil, and help improve our abilities to choose better in life. However, nothing is preordained in this pedagogic nudge. Implicit in this model of human birth, or more accurately the emergence of sentient beings, are two outcomes: one can very well ignore these stories and ideals of self-improvement and go on to accumulate more 'karmic' muck, or one can live as per these stories and steadily avoid 'karmic' burdens. The freedom to choose is yours. Amid all this, there remains a supervening question often left unanswered: what is this dharma that these stories speak of and point towards?

[...] 'Dharma' was the froth born from performing ritual. This efflorescence of meanings was vividly visible when the German linguist Karl Friedrich Geldner translated the *Rigveda* in 1928 and used 'no fewer than 20 renderings' – from 'law', 'order', 'duty' 'custom', 'quality' and so on – to describe dharma in various contexts.

In a recent conversation with Bibek Debroy, translator of the epic 10-volume Penguin edition of the *Mahabharata* (2015), he told me that: 'The basis of Sanskrit is the verbal root, the *dhatu* ... Looking at it from the point of view of the root, the verbal root – actually ['dharma'] is very, very precise.'

In this seemingly simple remark, however, lie the seeds of two distinct types of Indian thought, which began from the *Rigveda* and evolved over time: a 'verb-centric' understanding and a 'noun-centric' interpretation. As Daya Krishna put it in 1997, the verb-centric view spawned the long-lived Mimamsaka (hermeneutic) traditions that lay a premium on verbal declarations, injunctions, the ritual sacrifice, and ultimately a theology of action (*karma*) – for which 'dharma' was the froth born from performing ritual. In contrast, a noun-centric view grew into the Upanishadic

tradition that understood reality as being described by 'being' rather than by 'becoming'. This view elevated non-ritualistic speculations and methods of debate and, importantly, drew a link between reality and knowledge (*jnaana*). Thus, whereas for the Mimamsaka traditions, 'dharma' is tied to instruction and performance of action, for the Upanishadic worldview, dharma in its essence is born out of a transcendent ideal: truth.

Q9 What was the purpose of the author behind using the example of Karl Friedrich Geldner in the passage?

- (A) To demonstrate the evolution of Indian thought from a verb-centric to a noun-centric understanding of 'dharma'.
- (B) To illustrate the complexity and multiplicity of meanings associated with the term 'dharma' in different contexts.
- (C) To exemplify how the translation of ancient texts about dharma can reflect both the Mimamsaka and Upanishadic traditions.
- (D) To emphasize the significance of linguistic precision in understanding the verbal root 'dhatu' in Sanskrit.

Q10 The author uses the sentence "However, nothing is preordained in this pedagogic nudge" to imply:

- (A) Individuals have the autonomy to choose whether to follow the moral lessons from the stories or not, reflecting the freedom to either accumulate or avoid karmic burdens.
- (B) The concept of rebirth involves carrying past deeds and knowledge, yet individuals are not bound by these and can exercise their free will in every new life cycle.



(C) The stories provide a framework for moral cleansing, allowing listeners to consciously decide their path between adhering to dharma and accumulating 'karmic' muck.

(D) The depiction of dharma in the stories is a model for self-improvement through conscious effort, emphasising that adherence to these ideals is a choice rather than a predestined path

Q11 Which of the following sets of keywords most accurately reflects what the passage is all about?

(A) Puranas, dharma, moral exemplars, self-improvement, ritualistic sacrifice, karmic burden, Mimamsaka, Upanishadic tradition, philosophical foundations, linguistic analysis

(B) Moral education, linguistic analysis, cultural practices, ethical dilemmas, mythological stories, historical context, ritual symbolism, Mimamsaka, Upanishadic tradition

(C) Dharma, ritualistic practices, moral stories, philosophical debate, karmic consequences, ethical frameworks, cultural traditions, pedagogic value, linguistic analysis

(D) Ethical conduct, puranas influence, dharma meanings, historical evolution, moral reasoning, ritualistic practices, societal norms, philosophical foundations symbols of dharma

Q12 Which of the following options best describes the distinction between verb-centric and noun-centric interpretations of dharma?

(A) The verb-centric interpretation views dharma primarily through its ritualistic and performative aspects,

often linked to societal norms, whereas the noun-centric interpretation treats dharma as a set of unchanging, prescriptive laws that govern behavior.

(B) The verb-centric view considers dharma as a set of moral principles derived from historical rituals, while the noun-centric view focuses on dharma as a philosophical concept with a fixed, universal meaning across all contexts.

(C) The verb-centric interpretation of dharma emphasizes ritualistic actions and the performance of duties as outlined in the Mimamsaka traditions, while the noun-centric interpretation focuses on abstract, non-ritualistic ideals of truth and reality as emphasized by the Upanishadic tradition.

(D) The verb-centric interpretation sees dharma as a flexible and evolving concept tied to personal morality and ethical conduct, while the noun-centric interpretation rigidly defines dharma in terms of ancient rituals and religious duties.

Direction (13 - 16) Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

Directions: Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

Charles Taylor, who worked on the shop floor of the Wright Cycle Company, described the room above as 'frightened with argument'. He recalled: 'The boys were working out a lot of theory in those days, and occasionally they would get into terrific arguments. They'd shout at each other something terrible. I don't think they really got mad, but they sure got awfully hot.'



We're so familiar with the fact that the Wright brothers invented the aeroplane that the miraculous nature of their achievement goes unheralded. Wilbur and Orville were not scientists or qualified engineers. They didn't attend university and they weren't attached to any corporation. In fact, before their breakthrough, they'd accomplished little of note. So, just how did they come to solve one of the greatest engineering puzzles in history? Their success owes a lot to their talent for productive argument.

The brothers, four years apart, were close. 'From the time we were little children,' wrote Wilbur, 'my brother Orville and myself lived together, worked together, and in fact, thought together.' But that should not be taken to mean they had the same thoughts; the way they thought together was through argument. It was their father, Milton Wright, who taught them how to argue productively. After the evening meal, Milton would introduce a topic and instruct the boys to debate it as vigorously as possible without being disrespectful. Then he would tell them to change sides and start again. It proved great training. In *The Bishop's Boys* (1989), his biography of the brothers, Tom Crouch writes: 'In time, they would learn to argue in a more effective way, tossing ideas back and forth in a kind of verbal shorthand until a kernel of truth began to emerge.'

Wilbur Wright's description of collaborative intellectual enquiry is one the ancient Greeks would have recognised. Socrates believed that the best way to dispel illusions and identify fallacies was through the exchange of arguments. His took place in the town square of Athens, often with the city's most respected intellectuals. His favoured technique was to invite someone to say what they believed

(about the nature of justice, say, or happiness) before asking them why and how they could be so sure. Eventually, under persistent questioning, the fragility of the intellectual's initial confidence would be revealed.

Agnes Callard, associate professor of philosophy at the University of Chicago and an expert on the ancient Greeks, says that Socrates was responsible for one of the founding innovations of Western thought: what she calls the 'adversarial division of epistemic labour', in which one party's job is to throw up hypotheses, while the other's is to knock them down. This is exactly what happens in a modern courtroom as prosecutor and defender cooperate in a quest for justice by ripping each other's arguments apart. Even though Socrates himself was sceptical of democracy as a form of government, the idea that people with different views can vigorously yet co-operatively disagree is essential to democratic society.

Today, I believe we're in danger of losing touch with this principle. Open disagreement is associated with personal animus, stress and futility, partly because we see so many toxic fights on social media. Thanks to the popularisation of research into the flaws of human cognition, we've also become increasingly aware of how hard it is to argue without 'biases', such as the tendency to pick a side and stick to it rather than weighing evidence for different views dispassionately. It can be tempting, then, to avoid open argument altogether, but this merely transforms our differences into sullen resentment, while depriving us of a powerful tool of enquiry. An alternative is to propose that, when debates do take place, they should



be fastidiously civil, emotionally detached and unimpeachably rational.

Q13 Which of the following options best represent "adversarial division of epistemic labour" as mentioned in the passage?

- (A) A collaborative process where both parties contribute equally to the development of a shared understanding, minimizing conflict to maintain harmony.
- (B) A dialectical process where one party generates hypotheses and the other critically examines and tests their validity in the pursuit of knowledge.
- (C) A formal debate where opposing sides argue their cases, but personal biases and external influences are carefully controlled to ensure impartial judgment.
- (D) A structured intellectual discussion where participants focus on reinforcing each other's viewpoints to reach a consensus efficiently.

Q14 The example of Socrates is used in the passage with the purpose of:

- (A) Highlighting the philosophical method of uncovering contradictions, which influenced both ancient and modern approaches to conflict resolution and consensus building.
- (B) Emphasizing the importance of questioning established truths in order to challenge societal norms and promote individual freedom.
- (C) Demonstrating how Socratic questioning was aimed at exposing intellectuals' false confidence and how this technique contributed to the formation of democratic principles.

(D) Illustrating how adversarial argument can lead to the identification of fallacies and deeper understanding through critical dialogue.

Q15 What is the author trying to highlight in the last paragraph of the passage?

- (A) The risks of avoiding open argument and the potential for unresolved differences to turn into resentment.
- (B) The increasing futility of engaging in arguments due to cognitive biases and social media toxicity.
- (C) The importance of engaging in open argument, despite biases and emotional intensity, to prevent intellectual stagnation.
- (D) The danger of allowing modern research into human cognition to replace open debate and free expression of opinions.

Q16 What is the tone of the above passage?

- (A) Analytical (B) Cautionary
- (C) Reflective (D) Indifferent

Direction (17 - 21) Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

Directions: Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow.

The selected restaurant is called Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge and is located at 422 Northwest North River Drive, Miami, FL 33128. The core values of this restaurant are to provide their guests with a high-quality kitchen and impeccable hospitality. In addition, the restaurant focuses on seafood; however, vegan options are also available. The restaurant's commitment is to provide an insight into the aesthetics of the place. Moreover, it is feasible to say that visiting the website is essential before acquiring the place because it can help familiarize yourself with



the restaurant's features or any other organization. Therefore, it is interesting to assess Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge from the visitor's point of view. To start with, the abovementioned restaurant fits into the category of fine dining. This term means more than a simple kitchen; instead, the point is to make the guest happy. Everything matters in fine dining restaurants; for instance, the atmosphere is necessary, as well as the service, and definitely, the dishes. The menu of Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge can be called table d'hôte because it is relatively big and does not seem to change often. Moreover, the menu is divided into subcategories: appetizers, cocktails, entrees, brunch, pizze, salads, desserts, and bottle service menus. Thus, the table d'hôte menu contains appetizers and entrees for a fixed price. Interestingly, the restaurant can organize private events, and it becomes possible to order a whole branch or dinner and buy a set of fine wine bottles. The menu contains the names of dishes and their prices; however, there are no photos, making a choice blind. The type of food service is the assembly as the restaurant states to store, assemble, heat, and serve all food themselves. As for food quality, having chosen gorgonzola, pear, and black truffle pizze from the menu, it is possible to say that the dish tastes delicious. It is hard to select good-tasting gorgonzola because this cheese is rare among cheese products. Gorgonzola, pear, and truffle are classic combinations that constitute a good pizza, so the dish is classically good. However, the price is relatively high per one dish, which is 27 dollars. What is more, the service is not as perfect as expected; many reviews on this restaurant prove that waitresses might forget what the person has ordered, and the waiting time is long ("Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge," 2021). Concerning the set-up, the restaurant is located near the Miami River, and there is an

open-air summer veranda. Furthermore, there are tables for small and big companies, and it makes the tenure uncomfortable because of the crowded sitting places. The restaurant does not give much information about their kitchen equipment; however, it was noticed that pizze are prepared in traditional cooking ovens for pizzas. After the research on the Internet, it was investigated that a similar oven is found on eBay, and its price comprises 12,906 euros ("Mixed rotating gas-wood," 2021). For the chosen pizze, gas was required to cook it. Overall, the experience in this restaurant was pleasant; the chosen pizze was delicious, and the location was beautiful. Concerning the recommendations for this restaurant, it can be said that the location is perfect because the restaurant is placed near the river and it has a fantastic view. However, after studying the menu, it was noticed that there are no pictures of the dishes, which obstructs the choice. Moreover, waitresses make guests wait for a dish for a long time. Although the dishes taste delicious, the price is relatively high. Therefore, it can be recommended to develop customer service and adjust prices for this restaurant. In addition, it would be great to expand the sitting places because the restaurant may be overloaded with guests, especially on weekends. The last recommendation is to place the pictures of the dishes on the menu for customers to see what they order.

Q17 What can be inferred about the tone of the passage?

- | | |
|--------------|------------------|
| (A) Critical | (B) Appreciative |
| (C) Ironic | (D) Indifferent |

Q18 Which of the following best describes the style of the passage?

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------|
| (A) Persuasive | (B) Narrative |
| (C) Descriptive | (D) Expository |



Q19 What can be inferred from the passage about the food service at Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge?

- (A) The food service at Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge is exceptional and flawless, making it a popular fine dining restaurant in Miami.
- (B) The food service at Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge is subpar, as many reviews suggest that waitresses often forget orders, resulting in a long waiting time.
- (C) The food service at Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge is satisfactory, but the high prices make it unaffordable for most people.
- (D) The food service at Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge is adequate, but the crowded sitting places make the dining experience uncomfortable for guests.

Q20 What can be inferred from the passage about the menu of Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge?

- (A) The menu is small and changes often.
- (B) The menu is divided into several categories.
- (C) The menu contains pictures of dishes to help customers choose.
- (D) The menu only offers seafood options.

Q21 According to the passage, what are the main issues with Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge?

- (A) The menu does not contain pictures of dishes and the service is poor.
- (B) The prices are too high and the seating is uncomfortable.
- (C) The waitresses are forgetful and the restaurant is always crowded.

- (D) The kitchen equipment is not specified and the food takes too long to prepare.

Direction (22 - 26) Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

Directions: Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow.

The 20th century was the beginning of many social changes across the globe and several worldwide war conflicts that affected both Western and non-Western countries. Many of these are continuing to affect the world in the current 21st century as well. While it was a relatively short time compared to the rest of human history, its effect cannot be underestimated in terms of importance. World War I was the most prominent global conflict in the world at the time, and it tied both Western and non-Western nations as it had never happened before. While the conflict took less than a decade to conclude, its effects shattered people's perception of the world. For the first time in history, countries that came out as victors in the war were restricted from taking over defeated lands. The newly established mandate system declared that annexation was never Allied Forces' intention (Roberts and David 141). An anti-imperialist trend was growing in the 20th century, which coincided with a rise of colonial nationalism at the same time. The dissatisfaction of working and other marginalized social classes led to a growing demand for social and cultural changes across the globe, but especially in Russian Empire, British and French colonies, and the US (Glenda and Patricia 211). The United States became one of the most influential countries globally to the point that when the American stock market experienced the Great Crash, it affected the rest of the world, leading to the Great Depression (Roberts and David 180). When the USSR became a major powerhouse, the US was the



nation that opposed it the most, leading to the long lasting Cold War. While USSR eventually fell apart, the post-Soviet countries are still affected by its history. The shift from the 20th to the 21st century was when globalization grew as a global trend thanks to the booming Internet culture and technological advancements that allow people to interact regardless of distances or political and cultural differences. The 20th century can be considered an overall time of social and political change across the globe as it was rife with conflicts, changes, and advancements. Western and non Western worlds alike took part in the global conflicts and developed closer relations, although often for the latter's detriment. Even though a new century and new millennia began in 2000, the effects of previous decades still affect cultures, politics, and economies across the globe to this day.

- Q22** All of the following statements can be inferred from the passage EXCEPT that:
- (A) World War I led to the establishment of the mandate system.
 - (B) The Great Depression was caused by the Great Crash of the American stock market.
 - (C) The 20th century saw a shift from imperialism to colonialism.
 - (D) The Internet has allowed people to interact beyond boundaries.
- Q23** All of the following arguments are made in the passage EXCEPT that:
- (A) The 20th century was a time of great social and political change.
 - (B) The US was the nation that opposed the USSR the most.
 - (C) The Internet has allowed people to interact beyond boundaries.
 - (D) Imperialism was replaced with colonialism in the 20th century.

- Q24** What can be the tone of the passage?
- (A) Hopeful
 - (B) Ambitious
 - (C) Realistic
 - (D) Critical
- Q25** What is the style of the passage?
- (A) Persuasive
 - (B) Descriptive
 - (C) Narrative
 - (D) Expository
- Q26** Which one of the following statements, if true, would be the most direct extension of the arguments in the passage?
- (A) The rise of colonial nationalism during the 20th century was solely responsible for the anti - imperialist trend in the Western world.
 - (B) The Great Depression was a direct result of the American stock market crash of the 1920s.
 - (C) The impact of the Cold War on post-Soviet countries is still felt today.
 - (D) The 20th century was the only time in human history that countries were prevented from annexing defeated lands after a war.

Direction (27 - 30) Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

Read the given passages carefully and answer the questions given below each passage.

Manifestly political novels have always aroused some degree of suspicion. Orwell famously categorized Harriet Beecher Stowe's anti-slavery novel Uncle Tom's Cabin (1852) as a "good bad book" - crude yet effective - and Milan Kundera in turn dismissed Orwell's Nineteen Eighty-Four (1949) as "political thought disguised as a novel". In a devastating review, Whittaker Chambers said that Ayn Rand's colossal philosophical tract Atlas Shrugged (1957) "can be called a novel only devaluing the term... Its story merely serves



Miss Rand to get customers inside the tent, and as a soapbox for delivering her Message.”

Resistance to a message has only grown stronger since then. It seems that the tides of literary fashion have left the campaigning novel high and dry. “We’ve all drunk in the idea that you don’t reward a book for its subject matter but its literary craft,” Leith says. “while the consistency of the metaphors is fair game, the value of their ideas is less so.” This critical focus on form and language rewards a book as unusual as *Milkman* but creates a frosty climate for any author with a blatant reformist agenda.

“When you study literature, you learn the mantra that great art is not political,” agrees Joanna Kavenna, whose latest novel *Zed* is a wry satire about the unravelling of a supranational tech giant. “you read that ideas are somehow an imposition on fiction. But as soon as you create a character or write a story, you’re into an idea about society whether you like it not.” Influenced by Kafka, Gogol and the “tradition of unease”, Kavenna prefers to deploy irony to express the strangeness of modern life. More didactic fiction, she says, is prone to being dismissed as propaganda. “Writers like [William] Morris could be very certain: this is my political program, I want these outcomes. They were so sure of themselves and where they were in society. Our world is much more volatile and the audiences are much more sophisticated. People are so wary of blunt polemic – quite rightly – that we question the motives of everything all the time.”

It wasn’t always the case that readers recoiled from proselytizing fiction. Take for example, *Looking Backward: 2000- 1887* (1888). Wrapping his prospectus for American

socialism inside the tale of a Bostonian aristocrat who sleeps for 113 years and awakes in an egalitarian utopia, the journalist Edward Bellamy produced a colossal bestseller that was said to have introduced more Americans to socialism than Karl Marx. The book’s influence extended to suffragists, populists, HG Wells, Morris, Franklin D Roosevelt and Clement Attlee, who told Bellamy’s son Paul that their postwar Labor government was “a child of the Bellamy’s ideal.” Bellamy did not transform the world to the extent that he had hoped, but he certainly left it somewhat different.

Q27 Which of the following best describes the relation between the first and the last paragraphs?

- (A) The former presents a literary trend, while the latter gives an extension of the trend.
- (B) The former implies a generalization, while the latter gives an exception to that generalization.
- (C) The former implies a generalization about a literary genre, while the latter talks about another genre.
- (D) The former introduces a literary genre, while the latter summarizes the main argument of the passage.

Q28 It can be inferred that Joanna Kavenna and William Morris are likely to differ in which of the following?

- (A) While Joanna uses satire and irony as tools of her fiction, William Morris did not use these literary tools in his fiction.
- (B) While Joanna wrote fiction related to technology, William Morris wrote books only about politics.
- (C) Expression of political views is necessary for Joanna to create fiction,



while it is the purpose for William Morris.

(D) While Joanna's professional success is limited, William Morris' professional success is exemplary

Q29 The passage supplies information to answer all of the following questions EXCEPT:

(A) What kind of attitude does Chambers have towards the political implications of a literary work?

(B) What are the domains that are likely to be influenced by a political novel?

(C) What is the philosophical bent of Ayn Rand in her noted book Atlas Shrugged?

(D) Who are the literary figures that influenced the writing of Joanna?

Q30 Based on the passage, which of the following sequences best represents the

flow of discussion regarding political novels and their reception?

(A) Orwell's criticism Resistance to political novels Influence of Kafka and Gogol Dismissal of didactic fiction Bellamy's influence Historical examples

(B) Resistance to political novels Influence of Kafka and Gogol Bellamy's influence Orwell's criticism Dismissal of didactic fiction Historical examples

(C) Orwell's categorization Resistance to political novels Criticism of didactic fiction Influence of Kafka and Gogol Bellamy's influence

(D) Historical examples Orwell's categorization Influence of Kafka and Gogol Resistance to political novels Dismissal of didactic fiction Bellamy's influence



Answer Key

Q1 B
Q2 D
Q3 A
Q4 B
Q5 B
Q6 A
Q7 B
Q8 A
Q9 B
Q10 A
Q11 A
Q12 C
Q13 B
Q14 D
Q15 A

Q16 C
Q17 A
Q18 D
Q19 B
Q20 B
Q21 A
Q22 C
Q23 D
Q24 C
Q25 D
Q26 C
Q27 B
Q28 C
Q29 C
Q30 C



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Hints & Solutions

Note: scan the QR code to watch video solution

Q1. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Correct answer: B)

Hallucinations, as defined in the passage, are sensory experiences occurring without any external input or sensory cues. The passage contrasts hallucinations with illusions, where there is external input that is misinterpreted (e.g., a mirage). Thus, this option is the best representation of the core idea regarding hallucinations.

- **A)** is incorrect because it defines illusions rather than hallucinations. Illusions involve misinterpretation of external stimuli, which the passage distinguishes from hallucinations.
- **C)** is incorrect because it shifts focus to feelings of presence and emotional responses like anxiety or grief. While this might contribute to some perceptions, it's not the primary description of hallucinations provided in the passage.
- **D)** is incorrect because it introduces the concept of familiar stimuli (e.g., hearing voices) as a cause of hallucinations, but the passage emphasizes that hallucinations occur without any sensory input. It may be a secondary effect but does not fully capture the core idea of hallucination described.

Video Solution:



Q2. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Correct answer: D)

The passage does not associate hearing voices or seeing figures with the FP experience during sleep paralysis. While sleep paralysis and hypnagogic hallucinations are mentioned in the passage, the FP experience during sleep paralysis is described as a "feeling of presence," without any auditory or visual stimuli.

- **A)** is incorrect because the "third man" effect among survivors of extreme environments is specifically mentioned as an example of the FP experience.
- **B)** is incorrect because the passage explicitly states that people with Parkinson's disease report feelings of presence along with other hallucinations.
- **C)** is incorrect because grieving individuals experiencing the continued sensation of presence after a loved one's death is also mentioned as an example of FP.

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Q3. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Correct answer: A)

Option A provides a comprehensive set of keywords that best encapsulates the core ideas of the passage. It includes essential concepts like "hypnagogic" (referring to the experiences on the boundaries of sleep), "hallucinations," and "sleep paralysis"—key phenomena explored in the text. The keyword "presence" is critical since the passage revolves around the feeling of presence (FP) during sleep paralysis and other contexts like grief and paranoia. The inclusion of "sensory" and "illusion" captures the passage's distinction between hallucinations and misinterpretations of sensory input, or illusions. This option effectively ties together both the psychological and perceptual elements discussed.

- **B)** is incorrect because while it mentions hallucination types (auditory, visual, tactile), it misses the specific focus on "sleep paralysis" and the detailed analysis of the "feeling of presence" (FP), which is central to the passage. It also fails to mention significant psychological elements like grief and paranoia that contribute to FP.

- **C)** is incorrect because although it introduces "sensory input" and "stimuli," it omits key topics of discussion such as 'sleep paralysis' emotional and experiential aspects like grief and paranoia, which are essential for understanding the broader impact of FP. The passage emphasizes these emotional experiences (e.g., grief leading to feelings of presence) as a fundamental part of the FP phenomenon.
- **D)** is incorrect because, while it includes terms like "FP" and "anxiety," it overemphasizes "survival" and "illusion," which are not the primary focus. It misses the specific hypnagogic nature of hallucinations and sleep paralysis, which are key to understanding the scientific and experiential insights presented in the passage. Additionally, it leaves out grief, a major context for FP.

Video Solution:



Q4. Text Solution:

Explanation:

- **A)** is incorrect because while the passage distinguishes between hallucinations and illusions, the main focus is on the specific phenomenon of "feeling of presence"



(FP) rather than a broad exploration of hallucinations and illusions.

- **B)** is the **correct answer** as it encapsulates the core idea of the passage: an exploration of the mysterious feeling of presence (FP) and its occurrence in various contexts like sleep paralysis, grief, and survival situations. It captures the focus on both the experiential and scientific aspects of FP.
- **C)** is incorrect because it narrows the focus to hypnagogic hallucinations and sleep paralysis, which are important but don't fully capture the broader exploration of FP across different experiences (e.g., grief, survival stories).
- **D)** is incorrect because it overemphasizes sleep and paranoia while neglecting other significant contexts like survival stories and the grieving process, which are integral to understanding FP in the passage.

Video Solution:



Q5. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Correct Answer:

Option B offers the best continuation of the passage because it directly links Ruskin's ideas to the modern field of environmental psychology, which aligns with the passage's

exploration of the connection between environmental changes and mental health. It continues the theme of how the environment influences our mental state and suggests a contemporary relevance to Ruskin's thoughts.

Incorrect Answers:

Option A is incorrect because it introduces the idea of collective mindset influencing environmental issues, which, while related, shifts the focus from the passage's exploration of the impact of environmental changes on individual mental health.

Option C is incorrect because it suggests a return to simpler living and restoration of natural landscapes, which diverges from the passage's emphasis on understanding the psychological impact of environmental changes rather than advocating specific lifestyle changes.

Option D is incorrect because it emphasizes the need for scientific rigor and downplays the speculative nature of Ruskin's ideas, which contradicts the passage's suggestion that Ruskin's perspective, though unconventional, is worth considering in the context of modern environmental challenges.

Video Solution:



Q6. Text Solution:

Correct Answer:

Option A: is the correct answer because the passage reflects on Ruskin's observations and



critiques, analyzing the connection between environmental degradation during the Industrial Revolution and its impact on psychological well-being, as well as drawing parallels to modern-day environmental issues. Incorrect Answers:

Option B: Pensive and foreboding

This option suggests a tone that is contemplative and filled with a sense of impending doom. While the passage does involve deep reflection on the effects of industrialization and environmental changes, it does not primarily convey a feeling of inevitable disaster or dread. The tone is more reflective and analytical, focusing on understanding the connections between environmental degradation and psychological well-being rather than emphasizing a sense of looming catastrophe.

Option C: is incorrect because the passage does not convey a hopeful or positive outlook; rather, it discusses the negative impacts of industrialization and environmental change.

Option D: Critical and investigative

This option implies that the passage takes a critical stance and is actively probing or questioning the issues at hand. Although the passage does critique the impacts of industrialization and explores the implications of Ruskin's views, the overall tone is not purely critical or investigative. Instead, it leans more toward reflection and analysis, as it carefully considers the historical context, Ruskin's perspectives, and the broader implications for modern environmental concerns. The passage is more focused on drawing connections and insights rather than solely critiquing or investigating.

Video Solution:



Q7. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Correct Answer:

Option B is the correct answer as it directly supports Ruskin's argument that the environmental effects of industrialization contribute to psychological instability by providing historical evidence of a correlation between industrialization and mental health disorders.

Incorrect Answers:

Option A is incorrect because it, while relevant, introduces modern studies without directly tying them to the specific context of Ruskin's observations during the Industrial Revolution.

Option C is incorrect because it focuses on the validation of the physical existence of the 'plague-clouds' rather than the psychological implications of industrialization that the passage emphasizes.

Option D is incorrect because it challenges Ruskin's premise by suggesting that the weather patterns were natural rather than man-made, which would weaken rather than strengthen the passage's argument.

Video Solution:





Q8. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Option A: *Correct.* This option accurately reflects the purpose of the sentence in the passage. Ruskin's statement is used to introduce the idea that there is a deep connection between the environment and human emotions, which is central to his critique of industrialization and the societal changes it brought.

Option B: *Incorrect.* This option is extreme. Ruskin's argument behind the use of the sentence was to reflect a deep connection between the environment and human emotions. But it didn't claim that the emotional and psychological states of individuals are a direct reflection of the environmental conditions they live in.

Option C: *Incorrect.* This option is still about contrasting views between Ruskin and the scientific community, which isn't the main purpose of the sentence.

Option D: *Incorrect.* Although the sentence does connect environmental changes to moral implications, the primary focus is on the broader connection between the environment and human emotions.

Video Solution:



Q9. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Correct Answer: B. To illustrate the complexity and multiplicity of meanings associated with the term 'dharma' in different contexts.

Explanation:

Option A: This option is incorrect because, while the passage discusses the evolution of Indian thought, the example of Geldner is used to illustrate the varied meanings of 'dharma', not the transition from a verb-centric to a noun-centric understanding.

Option B: This is the correct answer because the author uses the example of Karl Friedrich Geldner's translation of the Rigveda to highlight the various meanings of 'dharma' ('law', 'order', 'duty', 'custom', 'quality', etc.). This demonstrates the term's complexity and the many contexts in which it can be understood.

Option C: This option is incorrect because Geldner's example specifically highlights the multiple meanings of 'dharma' rather than exemplifying both Mimamsaka and Upanishadic traditions. The passage does discuss these traditions, but not directly in the context of Geldner's translation.

Option D: This option is incorrect because the passage does not emphasize linguistic precision in the context of Geldner's



translation. The discussion about linguistic precision and the verbal root 'dhatu' is related to Bibek Debroy's comments, not Geldner's example.

Video Solution:



Q10. Text Solution:

Correct Answer: A. Individuals have the autonomy to choose whether to follow the moral lessons from the stories or not, reflecting the freedom to either accumulate or avoid karmic burdens.

Explanation:

Option A: This is the correct answer because the sentence "nothing is preordained in this pedagogic nudge" directly implies that individuals have the freedom to choose whether or not to follow the moral lessons from the stories. This freedom is central to the idea that people can either accumulate or avoid karmic burdens based on their choices, underscoring the autonomy in their moral decision-making.

Option B: This option is incorrect because, while it acknowledges free will, it places too much emphasis on the concept of rebirth and carrying past deeds and knowledge. The passage's focus is more on the present choices available to individuals rather than on the cumulative weight of past lives.

Option C: This option is incorrect because it highlights the role of the stories in providing a

framework for moral cleansing and the decision between adhering to dharma and accumulating karmic muck. Although related, it doesn't directly capture the implication of the specific sentence about nothing being preordained, which is more about the freedom of choice in the moment rather than a structured framework.

Option D: This option is incorrect because, while it discusses the model for self-improvement and emphasizes choice, it leans towards a broader interpretation of dharma and self-improvement. The specific sentence about nothing being preordained is more directly about the immediate freedom of choice in moral actions rather than a structured model for self-improvement.

Video Solution:



Q11. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Option A: This set of keywords accurately reflects the central themes of the passage. It includes "puranas" and "dharma," which are central to the discussion. Keywords like "moral exemplars," "ritual sacrifice," and "self-improvement" align with the focus on the puranas' role in illustrating moral ideals and the term 'dharma'. "Philosophical significance" and "narrative influence" capture the broader implications discussed in the passage. It also mentions Karmic burden as well as the two



Indian thoughts in Mimamsaka & Upanishadic traditions

Option B: Misses Dharma which is the central Keyword in the passage

Option C: Fails to highlight Mimamsaka & Upanishadic traditions. Less comprehensive than A

Option D: Fails to highlight Mimamsaka & Upanishadic traditions. Less comprehensive than A

Video Solution:



Q12. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Option A: This option incorrectly describes the noun-centric interpretation as treating dharma as a set of unchanging, prescriptive laws. The noun-centric interpretation actually emphasizes abstract and philosophical concepts rather than rigid laws.

Option B: This option incorrectly characterizes the verb-centric view as focusing on historical rituals and the noun-centric view as having a fixed universal meaning. The verb-centric interpretation is more about ritualistic actions and performance, while the noun-centric view focuses on philosophical ideals rather than a fixed, universal meaning.

Option C: This option correctly describes the distinction. The verb-centric interpretation emphasizes the role of rituals and actions as

described in the Mimamsaka traditions, focusing on the performance of duties. In contrast, the noun-centric interpretation, associated with the Upanishadic tradition, focuses on transcendent ideals like truth and reality, moving beyond ritualistic practices.

Option D: This option incorrectly describes the verb-centric view as flexible and evolving, and the noun-centric view as rigidly defined. The verb-centric interpretation emphasizes ritualistic actions, while the noun-centric interpretation focuses on philosophical and transcendent ideals, not necessarily rigidly tied to rituals.

Video Solution:



Q13. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Correct Answer: B) A dialectical process where one party generates hypotheses and the other critically examines and tests their validity in the pursuit of knowledge.

- **Explanation:** This option captures the essence of "adversarial division of epistemic labour" as described in the passage. The method involves one party proposing ideas or hypotheses while the other rigorously challenges and questions them to assess their validity. This critical exchange fosters a deeper



understanding and is likened to Socratic dialogue.

Incorrect Options:

A) A collaborative process where both parties contribute equally to the development of a shared understanding, minimizing conflict to maintain harmony.

- **Explanation:** This option misrepresents the adversarial nature of the process. The idea of "adversarial division" is not about minimizing conflict but about actively engaging in critical, opposing perspectives to test the strength of ideas. Harmony is secondary to truth-seeking in this context.

C) A formal debate where opposing sides argue their cases, but personal biases and external influences are carefully controlled to ensure impartial judgment.

- **Explanation:** While formal debate and the control of biases seem related, this option emphasizes impartial judgment and controlled environments, which do not directly align with the dynamic, back-and-forth nature of the adversarial method. The method thrives on critical opposition rather than merely controlling for biases.

D) A structured intellectual discussion where participants focus on reinforcing each other's viewpoints to reach a consensus efficiently.

- **Explanation:** This option emphasizes consensus and reinforcing viewpoints, which contrasts with the adversarial approach of challenging and deconstructing ideas. The goal in the adversarial division is not efficiency or agreement, but rather a rigorous

examination of ideas to uncover deeper truths.

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Q14. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Correct Answer: D) Illustrating how adversarial argument can lead to the identification of fallacies and deeper understanding through critical dialogue.

- **Explanation:** The example of Socrates is introduced to demonstrate the effectiveness of adversarial arguments, where questioning and critical exchange help reveal fallacies and contribute to intellectual growth, much like the Wright brothers' arguments.

Incorrect Options:

A) Highlighting the philosophical method of uncovering contradictions, which influenced both ancient and modern approaches to conflict resolution and consensus building.

- **Explanation:** This option incorrectly emphasizes conflict resolution and consensus building. The passage focuses on using argument to uncover fallacies, not necessarily to resolve conflicts or reach consensus.



B) Emphasizing the importance of questioning established truths in order to challenge societal norms and promote individual freedom.

- **Explanation:** While Socratic questioning does involve challenging established beliefs, the passage focuses on the pursuit of truth through argument, not on promoting individual freedom or challenging societal norms.

C) Demonstrating how Socratic questioning was aimed at exposing intellectuals' false confidence and how this technique contributed to the formation of democratic principles.

- **Explanation:** Although Socrates exposed intellectuals' false confidence, the passage explicitly mentions that Socrates was skeptical of democracy, so this option misrepresents the purpose of his method in relation to democratic principles.

Video Solution:



Q15. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Correct Answer: A) The risks of avoiding open argument and the potential for unresolved

differences to turn into resentment.

- **Explanation:** The last paragraph highlights how avoiding open disagreement can lead to sullen resentment and argues that productive argument is crucial, even in the face of cognitive biases and social media toxicity.

Incorrect Options:

B) The increasing futility of engaging in arguments due to cognitive biases and social media toxicity.

- **Explanation:** While cognitive biases and social media toxicity are discussed, the passage does not suggest that argument is futile, but rather that these challenges should be addressed without abandoning open debate.

C) The importance of engaging in open argument, despite biases and emotional intensity, to prevent intellectual stagnation.

- **Explanation:** Although this option is partially correct, the passage emphasizes preventing resentment more than intellectual stagnation. The author's main point is that avoiding disagreement can create hidden conflicts, rather than focusing on intellectual stagnation.

D) The danger of allowing modern research into human cognition to replace open debate and free expression of opinions.

- **Explanation:** The passage mentions modern research on cognition but does not suggest that it is replacing open debate or expression. The concern is more about people avoiding argument due to awareness of cognitive biases.

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Q16. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Correct Answer: C) Reflective

- **Explanation:** The passage is reflective as the author carefully considers the role of argument in intellectual inquiry, using historical examples to explore the significance of productive disagreement.

Incorrect Options:

A) Analytical

- **Explanation:** Although the passage involves analysis, it goes beyond breaking down ideas and focuses more on contemplating the broader implications of argument, making "reflective" a better fit than "analytical."

B) Cautionary

- **Explanation:** While the passage highlights concerns about avoiding argument, its overall tone is not one of warning but rather of thoughtful reflection on the role of disagreement, making "cautionary" less fitting.

D) Indifferent

Explanation: The passage is far from indifferent, as the author shows a strong

engagement with the subject of argument and its value in intellectual progress.

Video Solution:



Q17. Text Solution:

Explanation for the correct answer:

Option A: The tone of the passage is A) critical. The writer is evaluating the Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge restaurant from a visitor's point of view and analyzing its features, services, and quality. The tone is critical because the writer is pointing out the flaws and drawbacks of the restaurant. The following points illustrate the critical tone of the passage:

Flaws in Service: The writer mentions that the service is not perfect as expected, and waitresses may forget what the person has ordered, making the waiting time longer. This critique is evident from the following quote: "many reviews on this restaurant prove that waitresses might forget what the person has ordered, and the waiting time is long."

High Prices: The writer criticizes the restaurant for the high prices of the dishes. This is evident from the following quote: "However, the price is relatively high per one dish, which is 27 dollars."

Lack of Information: The writer criticizes the restaurant for not providing enough information about their kitchen equipment and not including photos of the dishes on the menu, making it difficult to choose. This is



evident from the following quote: "The restaurant does not give much information about their kitchen equipment; however, it was noticed that pizzettas are prepared in traditional cooking ovens for pizzas. After the research on the Internet, it was investigated that a similar oven is found on eBay, and its price comprises 12,906 euros... However, there are no photos, making a choice blind." Uncomfortable Environment: The writer criticizes the restaurant for the crowded sitting places, making the tenure uncomfortable for guests. This is evident from the following quote: "Furthermore, there are tables for small and big companies, and it makes the tenure uncomfortable because of the crowded sitting places."

" Recommendations for Improvement: The writer suggests improvements in customer service, adjusting prices, expanding sitting places, and placing photos of the dishes on the menu. This critique is evident from the following quote: "Therefore, it can be recommended to develop customer service and adjust prices for this restaurant. In addition, it would be great to expand the sitting places because the restaurant may be overloaded with guests, especially on weekends. The last recommendation is to place the pictures of the dishes on the menu for customers to see what they order."

Explanation for incorrect answers:

B. Appreciative - This option is not correct because the passage has a critical tone and the writer is pointing out the flaws and drawbacks of the restaurant.

C. Ironical - This option is not correct because the passage does not have a sarcastic or humorous tone. The writer is evaluating the restaurant and providing objective feedback based on their experience.

D. Indifferent - This option is not correct because the passage has a critical tone, and

the writer is providing specific feedback on the restaurant's features, services, and quality. The recommendations for improvement also demonstrate that the writer is not indifferent but rather actively engaged in providing feedback to improve the restaurant.

Video Solution:



Q18. Text Solution:

Explanation for the correct answer:

Option D: Expository, this style is characterized by explaining or providing information about a particular subject or concept, which matches the style of the passage. It is the correct answer. The passage describes the features and experience of a restaurant and provides recommendations for improvements.

Explanation for incorrect answers:

Option A: Persuasive, while the passage does make recommendations, it is not trying to persuade the reader to take a specific action.

Option B: Narrative, while there is a sequence of events described in the passage, it is not told in a story format.

Option C: It is not correct because it is providing information about a restaurant and giving an account of the author's personal experience at the restaurant. It also includes specific details about the restaurant's menu, prices, and service, and makes recommendations for improvement.

Video Solution:





Q19. Text Solution:

Explanation for the correct answer:

Option b: Option b is a possible inference from the passage because it is mentioned that many reviews suggest that the service is not as perfect as expected. The passage also states that the chosen pizzetta was delicious, but the price was relatively high, which may suggest that the food service is not exceptional or flawless. There are some issues with the service, such as forgetful waitresses and long waiting times, but the food quality is good. Hence, option B is the correct answer.

Explanation for incorrect answers:

Option A: It is not correct because the passage does not indicate that the food service at Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge is exceptional and flawless. In fact, many reviews suggest that the service may not be perfect, as waitresses often forget orders, and the waiting time is long.

Option C: It is incorrect because although the passage mentions that the prices at Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge are relatively high, it does not suggest that they make the restaurant unaffordable for most people. In addition, the passage states that the food quality is good, which may suggest that the prices are justified.

Option D: It can be a possible inference from the passage because it is mentioned that the sitting places can be crowded, which may make the dining experience uncomfortable for

guests. However, the passage does not suggest that the food service is inadequate due to the crowded sitting places. In summary, based on the information given in the passage, one can infer that the food service at Seaspice Brasserie & Lounge is satisfactory, but it may not be exceptional or flawless.

Video Solution:



Q20. Text Solution:

Explanation for the correct answer:

Option B: It is the correct answer. The passage states that the menu is divided into subcategories: appetizers, cocktails, entrees, brunch, pizzetta, salads, desserts, and bottle service menus.

Explanation for incorrect answers:

Option A: Incorrect. The passage states that the menu can be called table d'hôte because it is relatively big and does not seem to change often.

Option C: It is not correct. The passage states that the menu contains the names of dishes and their prices, however there are no photos, making a choice blind.

Option D: It is Incorrect. The passage states that the restaurant focuses on seafood, but also offers vegan options.

Video Solution:





Q21. Text Solution:

Explanation for the correct answer:

Option A: It is correct. The passage states that one issue with the restaurant is that the menu does not contain pictures of dishes, which can make it difficult for guests to make a choice. Additionally, the passage mentions that the service is not as perfect as expected, with reviews indicating that waitresses may forget what guests have ordered and the waiting time is long.

Explanation for incorrect answers:

Option B: It is not entirely correct as the passage describes that the dishes taste delicious, but the price is relatively high, but it is not too high.

Option C: This is not entirely correct as the passage describes that the seating is uncomfortable because of the crowded sitting places and not because of the waitresses.

Option D: It is not entirely correct as the passage describes that the kitchen equipment is not specified but it was noticed that pizzettas are prepared in traditional cooking ovens for pizzas and not that food takes too long to prepare.

Video Solution:



Q22. Text Solution:

Explanation for the correct answer:

Option C: The correct answer is option c. The 20th century saw a shift from imperialism to colonialism. The passage states that the 20th century was a time of social and political change across the globe, with the rise of anti-imperialism coinciding with the rise of colonial nationalism. It then goes on to discuss the effects of World War I and the Great Depression, which had global implications. Additionally, the passage states that the 20th century was a time of technological advancements that allowed people to interact regardless of distances or political and cultural differences. However, the passage does not suggest a shift from imperialism to colonialism, which is why this option is the correct answer.

Explanation for incorrect answers:

Option A: The passage states that World War I led to the establishment of the mandate system and the victors in the war were restricted from taking over defeated lands in that, this shows that it can be inferred from the passage.

Option B: It is mentioned that the Great Depression was caused by the Great Crash of the American stock market, as it is stated in the passage that 'the American stock market experienced the Great Crash, it affected the



rest of the world, leading to the Great Depression', so it cannot be the answer.

Option D: The Internet has allowed people to interact beyond boundaries is also discussed in the passage. So, it can be inferred.

Video Solution:



Q23. Text Solution:

Essence of the question:

There are some arguments quoted in the passage. We need to choose that option, that does not quote the argument.

Explanation for the correct answer:

Option D: Imperialism was replaced with colonialism in the 20th century. The passage states that an anti-imperialist trend was growing in the 20th century, which coincided with a rise of colonial nationalism at the same time. However, the passage does not suggest that imperialism was replaced with colonialism, which is why this option is the correct answer.

Explanation for incorrect answers:

Option A: 'The 20th century was the beginning of many social changes', is discussed in the passage. So, this option is mentioned in the passage and it cannot be the answer.

Option B: It is stated 'when the USSR became a major powerhouse, the US was the nation that opposed it the most', thus this is mentioned in the passage and cannot be the answer.

Option C: The Internet has allowed people to interact beyond boundaries is also discussed in the passage. Thus, this cannot be the answer.

Video Solution:



Q24. Text Solution:

Essence of the question:

It is a tone based question. This asks us about the feeling of the author or attitude of writer in writing this passage.

Explanation for the correct answer:

Option C: Realistic. The passage discusses the events of the 20th century in a factual and non-emotional manner. While it does point out the social and political changes and the effects of previous decades, it does not take a firm stance on any particular issue, which suggests a realistic tone.

Explanation for incorrect answers:

Option A: We do not see that the author is shopping for something. Thus, it cannot be the tone of the author.

Option B: The passage does not indicate that the author is ambitious about any issue, so it cannot be the answer.

Option D: Critical tone means fault finding tone, however the passage does not suggest that.

Video Solution:





Q25. Text Solution:

Explanation for the correct answer:

Option D: The passage is an expository style, which is defined as a type of writing that is used to explain, inform, or describe a subject. The passage provides an overview of the major social changes and conflicts that occurred in the 20th century and how they continue to affect the world in the 21st century. The writer uses factual information and historical evidence to support their argument and presents the information in a neutral and objective manner.

Explanation for incorrect answers:

Option A: Persuasive is not correct because the passage does not attempt to persuade the reader to adopt a particular point of view. The writer presents the information in an objective manner and does not try to convince the reader to agree with a particular viewpoint.

Option B: Descriptive is not correct because the passage does not focus on describing the physical characteristics of a particular place or object. The writer provides an overview of historical events and social changes that occurred in the 20th century.

Option C: Narrative is not correct because the passage is not a story with a plot and characters. The writer provides a factual overview of historical events and social changes that occurred in the 20th century, rather than telling a story. Overall the passage

is written in a manner that is objective, informative and neutral, which are the hallmarks of an Expository style.

Video Solution:



Q26. Text Solution:

Explanation for the correct answer:

Option C: Option c is a plausible answer because the passage talks about how the Cold War had a lasting impact on post-Soviet countries. The text states that even though the USSR fell apart, its history still affects the region. Therefore, this option is not too broad or too narrow, and it is not strange or extreme. It is a direct extension of the arguments in the passage.

Explanation for incorrect answers:

Option A: It can be eliminated because it is too narrow. The passage mentions that anti-imperialist trends were growing in the 20th century, but it also points out that there were other factors such as the mandate system and World War I that led to changes in perceptions of annexation. Therefore, this option is too narrow to be the most direct extension of the passage.

Option B: It can be eliminated because it is too extreme. The passage states that the American stock market crash of the 1920s affected the rest of the world, leading to the Great Depression, but it does not say that it was the only cause. There were other factors such as



bank failures, reduction in purchasing, and international trade policies that contributed to the economic crisis. Therefore, this option is too extreme to be the most direct extension of the passage.

Option D: This is too broad because the passage does not make a claim that this is the only time in history that countries were prevented from annexing defeated lands. It only states that the mandate system declared that annexation was never Allied Forces' intention after World War I. Therefore, this option is too broad to be the most direct extension of the passage. In conclusion, option c is the most direct extension of the arguments in the passage because it is not too broad, too narrow, or too extreme, and it directly relates to the passage's discussion on the lasting impact of the Cold War on post-Soviet countries.

Video Solution:



Q27. Text Solution:

In the first paragraph, the author gives some examples in which the political novels were criticized, and the last paragraph gives a political novel that is respected a lot. This sense is expressed by Option (B), which is the best option.

Option (A): incorrect because, while the former certainly presents a literary trend, the last paragraph does not present the extension of

the trend: in fact it gives an instance of an earlier time and a trend that is opposite to the one given in the first paragraph.

Option (B): correct as per the reasons given above.

Option (C): incorrect because the last paragraph too talks about the same genre of political novels.

Option (D): incorrect because the last paragraph does not summarize the main argument of the passage.

Thus, the best option is Option (B).

Video Solution:



Q28. Text Solution:

By reading the first four sentences of the third paragraph, Joanna feels that political ideas are imposed on the fiction the moment we create a character. She explicitly mentions more didactic fiction is prone to dismissal. All this implies that she expresses political ideas as a part of character creation or development, while Morris explicitly mentions the political purpose of the book. This distinction is given in Option (C), which is the best option.

Option (A): incorrect because the info given about Morris does not imply that he did not use irony and satire.

Option (B): incorrect because the info given about Morris does not support the idea that he wrote only about politics.



Option (C): correct as per the reasons given above.

Option (D): incorrect because the Professional success is not compared in the passage.

Thus, the best option is Option C.

Video Solution:



Q29. Text Solution:

For this type of question, we need to verify each option individually to arrive at the correct option by elimination.

Option (A): incorrect because the last sentence of the first paragraph indicates that Chambers has a highly negative attitude towards political nature of a fiction.

Option (B): incorrect because the last but one sentence of the passage lists out suffragist movement, populist movement and government as the fields that were influenced by the political work of Bellamy.

Option (C): correct because, though the last sentence of the first paragraph does mention her expressing a philosophical bent, we cannot infer what that philosophical bent is.

Option (D): incorrect because we can find the list of people who influenced Joanna, in the third paragraph

Thus, the best option is Option (C)

Video Solution:



Q30. Text Solution:

Explanation:

Option C is correct because it accurately follows the sequence of key points in the passage:

1. **Orwell's categorization:** Orwell's views on Harriet Beecher Stowe's and Ayn Rand's works.
2. **Resistance to political novels:** The current critical climate against campaigning novels.
3. **Criticism of didactic fiction:** Joanna Kavenna's view on the dismissal of politically charged fiction.
4. **Influence of Kafka and Gogol:** Kavenna's influence and preference for irony.
5. **Bellamy's influence:** The historical impact of Edward Bellamy's *Looking Backward*.

Option A is incorrect because it starts with Orwell's criticism and skips directly to Bellamy's influence without following the flow of the passage's progression.

Option B is incorrect because it places Bellamy's influence too early in the sequence and does not maintain the proper order of discussion.



Option D is incorrect because it begins with historical examples and does not follow the flow of discussion about the reception and criticism of political novels.

Video Solution:



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